Contents

Chapter 1

conventions

1.1 Forcing Pass

1.1.1 Forcing Pass

```
FP on if GF
FP if a non-rejected inv(+) forcing bid is interfered below the forcing
    level
after 2C opening
after 2N opening interfered to 3N+
low level natural XX FP on until 2N
(2X/3X/4X) - P - (5X) - FP on if not PH
(2X/3X/4X) - bid/X - (5X) - FP on
# however, not necessarily FP on after a pen X or converted pen X
```

1.2 game (slam) try after 2M fit

We probably agree that short-suit game try and help-suit are very helpful. Also, Jacoby has told us slam with long side suit is also important. I think it's very easily combine these into a Jacoby-2N like structure:

```
sure fit in 2S -
2N = ask, help-suit GT-ish
   3X = help in X  # void/x/xx/A/K/Q
   3S = min, scattered values
   3N = max, scattered values
   4X = spl
3X = short suit GT/ST. No interest in CoG. Only cares about waste in X
   (or extra trumps)
3S = 6+S inv, but semi-pre
3N = CoG  # jump to 3N is CoG. otherwise 3M+1 = FF
```

```
4X = 5-5 or 4-6, ST

# for 2H: 2S = ask, and exchange the meaning of 2N and S
# if resp promises (usually) unbal (i.e. 1D opener), then after ask: 3X
    = spl, 4X = void spl
```

1.3 Lebensohl-ish, and good-bad 2NT

1.3.1 Lebensohl

It is widely agreed that distinguishing ranges using 2N as artificial (i.e. Lebensohl) is very beneficial. However, we need to define the "cases" carefully:

- this only applies to advancer or responder
- forced 2N by t/o = normal Lebensohl
- (P/bid) - 1N - (2X) - 2N or (1Y) - X - (2X/2Y) - 2N = transfer Lebensohl. (because these are free bids)
- t/o twice, or resp shows 0-5, or t/o'er passed, 2N = scramble
- other free 2N = nat unless otherwise specified

```
# normal Leb: ... (2X)
2Y = NF
2N → 3C = min, or GF with stopper  # min: 0-7(8) for (almost)
   unlimited, 0-4 for 0-7 (i.e. failed to neg X)
    # anti-transfer: GF even against min range
    3X = s/o
    3cue = 4oM (or some 4M) with stopper
    3N = stopper
    3Y = nat inv NF  #
    # if interfered: X shows the above hand and tend to PEN
3X = nat constr NF  # (8)9-11 for (almost) unlimited, 5-7 for 0-7
jump 3Y = 5+Y GF
3cue = 4oM (or some 4M) w/o stopper
3N = no stopper
4m = GF with extra, SI
4M = s/o. either long M with constr values, or (4)5+M will full values

# transfer Leb: ... (2X)
2N → 3C = want to s/o 3X, or SI with C
3CDH = transfers. transfer to opp's suit = ask 4M
3S = ask for stopper
```

```
3N = s/o
after 2N/3CDH, cue = ask for stopper or ST. new suit = nat
```

1.3.2 good-bad 2NT

Similar for opener's rebid, in competition, using 2N to distinguish ranges are also common practices. We also need to define the cases carefully: suppose the auction goes `1X - (A) - B - (C)`

- B should never be P. i.e. if resp passes, there are never good-bad. (note: if resp passes, then 2N is unusual)
- (1) C > 2X
- (2) 1X - (jump overcall) - X - (P)
- (3) 1S - (2H) - X - (P)

```
# if not forced
P = nothing special
X = t/o
# no matter forced or not
2X = nat
2N = transfer to 3C, then bid/P = comp (or min if forced)
    3C = accepted. min.
    3X = s/o
    3Y (resp's suit) = this is a special case:
        if it is not possible for him to inv => s/o  # ex: 1m - (1S) -
   X ...
        if there are cuebid availble under Y => s/o
        otherwise => GF
    other = GF
bid = (mild) inv. if resp already shows inv, then GF.

# One only exception is that, if partner shows a inv+ 5+M, then showing
    fit is too urgent so that direct 3M is just min. However, good-bad
   is still on, just usually won't have M fit.
```

1.3.3 extended good-bad 2NT

not now, but maybe in the future

1.4 ST gadgets

We use some kickbacks here.

1.4.1 non-serious 3M+1 and 3N

```
# If we fit in M:
jump to 3N = CoG
otherwise, 3M+1 = non-serious

# If we fit in m:
3N = non-serious
```

1.4.2 Jacoby

```
After 2M+1 or 2N shows inv+ or GF fit:

3X = spl, ST (or GT)  # 1H - 2S - 2N = spl S
4X = 5-5+ ST, usually with controls in two other suits
3M+1 = always non-serious, no CoG
# if inv+
3M < 3M+1 (mild ST) < 4M
# if GF
4M < 3M+1 (mild ST) < 3M

# If overcalled:
bid = system ON
X = suggest PEN
back to M = weakest
[overcall < 3M] P = stolen
[overcall > 3M] P = SI
```

1.4.3 RKC, EKRC, 2RKC

When not in doubt, we use kickback RKC:

```
# 4X+1 = RKC
+1 = 0/3 keycards
    +1 = ask Q
+2 = 1/4 keycards
    +1 = ask Q
+3 = 2/5 keycards, w/o Q
+4 = 2/5 keycards, w/ Q
+5 = even keycards, some void
```

```
+6 or higher = odd keycards, the bid suit is void. However, if spl
   before, then bid K.
(X)
    ignore
(+1) or (+2) # interfered: DOP1 & DEP0
    X = 0/3 keycards
        +1 = ask Q
    P = 1/4 keycards
        X = PEN
        +1 = ask Q
    +1 = 2/5 keycards, w/o Q
    +2 = 2/5 keycards, w/ Q
    +3 = even keycards, some void
    +4 or higher = odd keycards, the bid suit is void. However, if spl
   before, then bid K.
(+3) or above
    X = even keycards
    P = odd keycards
        X = PEN
        +1 = ask Q
    bid = system on

5X = exclusion RKC, ask for keycards except X  # 4N replaces X+1 if
   kickback
+1 = 0-0.5
+2 = 1
+3 = 1.5
+4 = 2
...
```

When there's no sure fit shown, or is competed, `4N`, or even `5N` is RKC. When a sure doublefit is shown (note: a "scramble fit" is not considered a doublefit), or we showed 5-5 against a balanced hand, we use 2RKC:

```
4A, 2K in the fit suit, 2Q (0.5 each) in the fit suit
two Q is 0.5 + 0.5 = 1
response 0/3/6 (+0.5), 1/4/7 (+0.5), 2/5, 2.5/5.5
the original ask Q is asking whether there are an extra +0.5
```

1.4.4 5N

In order of priority:

- RKC if fit and no 4N available
- choice of slam

1.4.5 ... 4M - 5M

- ask control if opp bids one suit
- general inv

1.5 doubles

1.5.1 support

- is not ON against a natrual 1N
- does not apply to D
- does not apply to `1H - 1N*- (bid)`
- this is semi-obligatory: you may pass with many wastes in opps suit and min

1.5.2 negative

See 1X interfered.

1.5.3 responsive

Traditional.

1.5.4 Lightner

X against a voluntarily bid game/slam, if not slam-sacrifice or have showed power (thus PEN), is requesting a "strange" lead:

- if LDX before, CANCELS IT
- if overcalled before, request DON'T LEAD
- against suit, usually have a void
- against jump to slam or NT, maybe have AK in a side suit
- lead dummy's suit
- lead declarer's suit

1.5.5 maximum X/XX, negative XX, LDX, LDXX

PEN, optional, and maximum, and t/o

1.5.6 slam sacrifice double

This is a very good tool and usually won't hurt (it only sacrifices a PEN or Lightner). The way it work is: We have a preemptive or competetive raise to the 4-level where FP does not apply, and opps bid to slam. Then:

```
... (6X) -
X = 2+ winners
P = 0-1 winners
    X = ask with exactly 1 winner
        P = I have 1 winner
        bid = I have 0 winners
    P = to play. may be 2+ winners, or want to defend, or just don't
   want to sacrifice
    bid = sac
```

1.6 misc

1.6.1 fit-showing jump

A jump is fit-showing (almost) iff PH. Showing 9+ cards and concentrated strength in the two suits, and inv if not interfered, and pre to constr otherwise. In other senarios:

- if we are opener, jump is weak (except 1M - X)
- if we are overcaller, jump is invitational
- if we are overcaller, and opp shows inv+, jump is weak and fit-showing

TODO: after (pre 3C) or pre 3C, 3D/H/S = inv+ H/S/D

1.7 vs artificial bids

To tackle those artificial bids' problem, we need classify them into:

- transfers: promising only 1 known (5+ cards) suit
- multi: promise 1 unknown suit
- assumed-fit: promises 0 or 2+ suits: take-out, Michaels, unusual, fertilizer, etc.

- art fit
- multi-way bids that is not above

Situations can also be classified into:

- opponents opened pre (or non-pre, ex: Flannery or precision 2D)
- we opened and are overcalled (since in this case partner has promised some strength)

1.7.1 principles

General principles are:

- advances are generally natrual if it's not opponents suit
- opponents 5+ card suit usually treated as cuebid (meaning might vary)
- if we opened NT, then transfer Leb applied
- P then bid shows a weaker hand. but P then X may vary.
- however, if we already have other methods, then use it (ex: supp X)

1.7.2 vs transfers

- X = t/o and may be lighter than usual (X then X: slightly stronger than usual)
- P then X = PEN if partner opened or they preempted. otherwise still t/o.
- P then bid = often lighter
- direct cuebid = same as original (usually: Michaels, or fit)
- others = same as original

Here are some common situations:

```
(3D = 6+H pre or some stronger hand) -  # transfer pre
X = 13+, t/o  # then X = 16+, t/o
P then X = PEN
3H = Western

(1N) - (2H = 5+S) -  # Jacoby transfer
X = 9+, t/o
```

```
P then X = strong bal
2S = Michaels

(1N) - (4H = 6+S) -
X = 9+, t/o
P then X = strong bal
4S = Michaels
4N = unusual (mms)

1N - (2D = 6+H) -  # transfer overcall
X = can be less than inv, t/o
P then X = PEN
2H = Michaels
P then 2N = m-oriented t/o

# vs Rubens
1C - (1S) - 1N - (2D = H);
X = t/o
2H = good D (4-th suit)
2S = good C (good raise)

# vs Rubens II
1C - (1S) - X - (2C = D);
X = supp. 3H.
2D = I think good fit (UvU)
2S = strong general t/o, F1.

(1C) - (1H = 4+S) -  # transfer response
X = 9+, t/o
1S = Michaels
2C/2S = nat (same as original)

(1D = 4+H) -
X = 9+, t/o
1H = Michaels
2H = uncertain. maybe good 6+H, but if 1D promises 5+H then probably
   still Michaels.
3H = Western  # same as original
```

1.7.3 vs assumed-fit & unusual

We need to talk about penalty scheme first. When partner opens and opp uses multi or assumed-fit bids:

- P then X = inv+, flat (bal) hand. partner can choose to defend or bid natrually

- X then P/X = PEN in at least one suit. usually sharper so subseq P implies t/o (opener's X is coop)

If they t/o or does not promises a 5-card suit, then we simply use system on, or natrual, or otherwise specified. (note: please check our defense to t/o) Otherwise, we use unusual-vs-unusual:

```
# we showed 1 suit, they showed 1 suit (or only one cuebid available)
cue = inv+ raise
raise = constr
jump cue = spl
(2N = mixed raise)
others = nat F

# we showed 1 suit, they showed 2 suits
highest cue under partner's suit = inv+ raise
other cue = inv+ 4-th suit
jump cue = spl
(2N = mixed raise)
others = nat and comp, NF

# we showed 0 suits, they showed 2 suits
case-by-case

# we showed 2 suits, they showed 2 suits:
treated as we showed 1 suit (i.e. high cue = inv fit)
```

Here are some common situations:

```
# unless specified otherwise:
XX = inv+, at least PEN in one suit
P then X = inv+, flat

1m - (X) -  # recall
1N = constr+ C
2C = NF
2N = inv fit.
others = system ON

1M - (X) -  # recall
1N ~ 2M-2 = transfers  # to suit = usually weak
2M-1 = at least 1M - 2M
2M+ = same

1m - (2m = MMs) -
2H = inv+, om
2S = inv+ fit m  # higher cue
3m/om = nat NF
```

```
3M = probably spl

1M - (2M = oM + unknown m) -
XX = inv+, at least PEN in one suit  # usually PEN oM, but can be PEN
   both ms!
2N = "the 2N raise"  # if oM = H, then this is inv+; if oM = S, then
   this is mixed raise
3m = nat F

1D - (P) - 1H - (2N = S+C) -
3C = inv+ H raise  # highest cue under partner's suit
3D = NF
3H = NF
3S = GF D

# 0-vs-2 suit senarios: X and P then X are still the same!
1N - (2C = MMs) -
2D = nat NF
2H = inv, minor-oriented t/o
2S = GF, minor-oriented t/o
2N+ = transfer Leb (still need to show 5+M)
4DH = still transfers

1C/1N - (2N = mms) -
X = inv+, at least PEN in one suit. or SI with 5+M.
P then X = inv+, flat.
3C = inv+, 5+S; or inv+ t/o with 4+S
    3D = GF w/o 4S. ask
        3H = 4+H
            3S = 3S
        3S = 5+S
        3N = 5+H, 4S  # need memorize!
    3H = min, usually 4+H. P/C
        P = s/o  # inv
        3S = s/o  # inv, 5+S, 3-H
        3N = 5S, 3-H, GF.
        4H = s/o
    3S = min NF
    3N = no 3S, no 4H.
    4C+ = 4+S fit, cuebid  # 4S = s/o
3D = inv+, 5+H, usually 3-S. or GF, 5+H 4S.
[1N...] 4CDH = system ON
```

1.7.4 vs assumed-fit pres

If they open preempt, we might need more case-by-case analysis.

```
# default to Dixon defense
(2D/H = MMs) -
X = 13-15, (s)bal  # then still Leb. subseq X = PEN
P then X = t/o
2H (if available) = nat
2S = t/o
2N = 16-18, bal
3m = nat
3M = nat, good hand

(2D = fertilizer/Jamming) -
X = 13-15 (s)bal; or X then bid.  # then still Leb. subseq X = PEN
P then X = t/o
2M = nat
2N = 16-18 bal
3X = nat

(2N = mms) -
X = 14+ (s)bal; or X then bid.  # then still Leb. subseq X = PEN
P then X = PEN
3C = t/o. S >= H.
    +1 = ask if S > H
3D = t/o. H > S.
3M = nat

# vs constr: 13-15 bal is not urgent to show
(2D = Flannery, 45xx+) -
X = 14+ (s)bal  # then still Leb. adv's X = PEN
P then X = t/o
2H = t/o  # Leb ON. adv's X = responsive
2S = nat
2N = mms t/o
3m = nat
3H = Western
3S = 16-18, good 6+S

(2H = Flannery, 45xx+) -
X = 15+ (s)bal  # then still Leb. adv's X = PEN
P then X (if available) = t/o
2S = NF. t/o to H.
others = same

(2D = 4414, 4405, 4315, 3415) -  # treated as opened 2C, since he
   usually has 5+C
X = t/o of C
P then X = t/o
2M = nat
```

```
2N = 16-18
3C = Michaels
3DHS = nat

(2H = 4414, 4405, 4315, 3415)
X = t/o of C
others = same
```

1.7.5 vs multi

Multi is hard to defend.

```
(2D = multi) -
X = 12-17, some 5+M; or 19-21 bal  # subseq = same as multi
P then X = 13-15 bal or slightly off-shape
2M = t/o in M  # subseq = same as (2M) - X. However, jump to 4M shall
   be natrual
2N = nat 15-18
3m = nat
3M = 15-17, 6+M

(2D = multi) - P - (P) -
X = 13-15, bal or t/o; or some stronger off-shape hand
2M = nat overcall
2N = 16-18, bal
others = same

(2D) - P - (2M/3M) - X = t/o (treated as nat pre)

1N - (2D = multi) -
X = PEN in at least one M  # may be some 5M
2M = t/o in M
P then X = inv+. flat hand.
2N+ = transfer Leb

1N - (2D = multi) - P - (P/2M/3M); X = t/o
```

1.7.6 vs art fit

```
X to spl = suggest sacrifice
X to non-GF raise = t/o
X to GF raise = LDX
```

1.7.7 vs other & multi-way bids

```
unless otherwise specified, X to multi-way bids (ex: 1S - 2C = C or S)
   are LDX
XX to negative double = lead-directing
XX to responsive double = suggest not to compete
XX in other situations = general strength or lead-directing
(2N = nat) - X = MMs
```